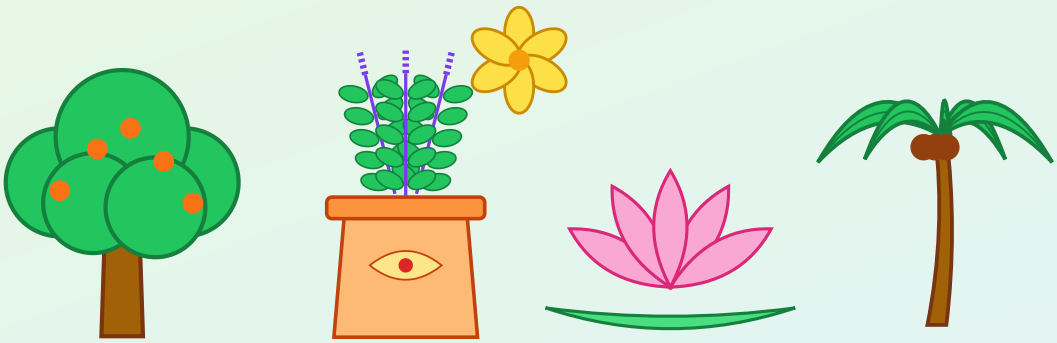
वृक्षाः ओषधयश्च

My Sanskrit Indian Plants Workbook

संस्कृत-वृक्ष-ओषधि-अभ्यास-पुस्तिका

Plant parts · sacred & Indian trees · flowers · spices · grains · ślokas · grow a tulasī · leaf match · word search · colouring

Name / नाम: _____



For EdNet Learn members · ednetlearn.in

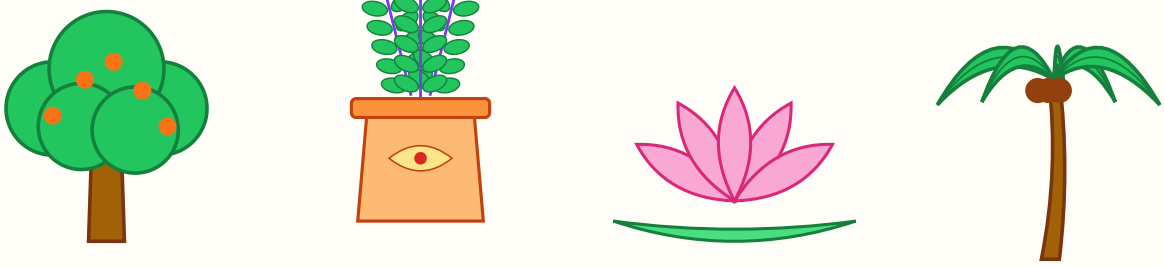
How to use · Contents

1. Read each plant name aloud: Devanagari first, then the sound (transliteration).
2. Learn the English and botanical names, and how the plant is used in Indian homes and festivals.
3. Learn the ślokas slowly, one line a day.
4. Do the activities: the tulasī log, leaf match, word search and colouring. Answers are at the end.

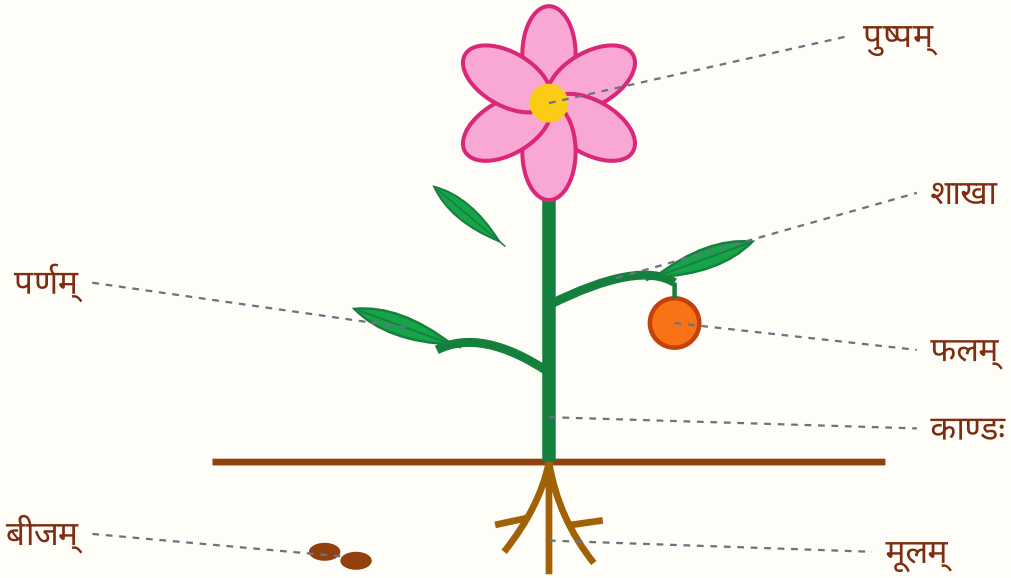
Contents

Section	Page
Parts of a plant · वृक्षस्य अङ्गानि	3
Sacred & Indian trees and plants	5
Ślokas for tulasī and aśvattha	9
Flowers · पुष्पाणि	10
Spices · सुगन्धद्रव्याणि	12
Grains · धान्यानि	13
Simple sentences & a subhāṣita	15
Grow a tulasī · activity log	16
Leaf match, word search, colouring, quiz	17
Answer key · उत्तराणि	21

> Plant uses in this book are traditional and cultural. Please ask a doctor before using any plant as medicine.



Parts of a plant · वृक्षस्य अङ्गानि

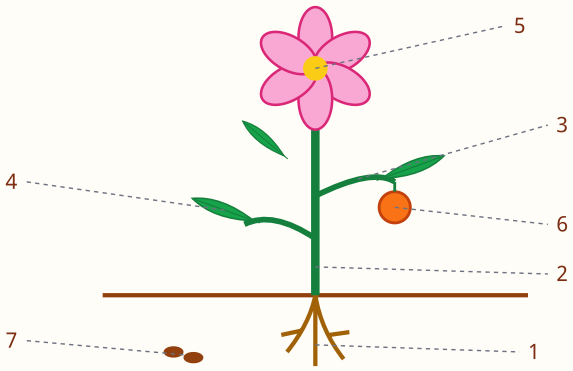


Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
मूलम्	mūlam	root
काण्डः	kāṇḍaḥ	stem, trunk
शाखा	śākhā	branch
पर्णम् · पत्रम्	parṇam · patram	leaf
पुष्पम्	puṣpam	flower
फलम्	phalam	fruit
बीजम्	bījam	seed

वृक्षः (vṛkṣaḥ) tree · पादपः (pādapaḥ) plant (“drinks with its feet”, i.e. roots) · लता (latā) creeper · ओषधिः (oṣadhiḥ) herb, plant

Practice: parts of a plant

Label the picture: write the Sanskrit word for each number.



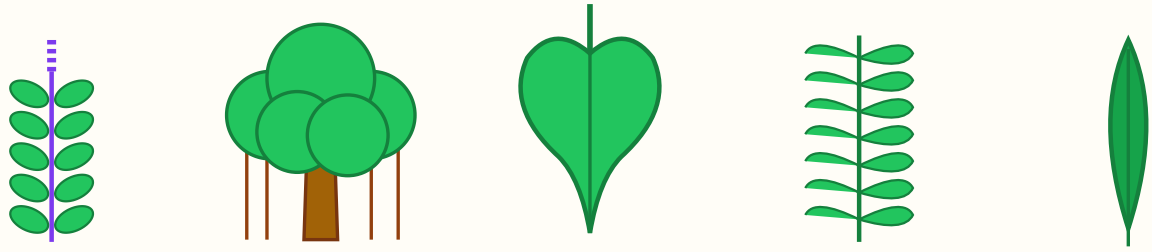
1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____

Fill in

1. The plant drinks water through its _____ (root).
2. A bee visits the _____ (flower).
3. A new plant grows from a _____ (seed).
4. Two words for leaf: _____ and _____.

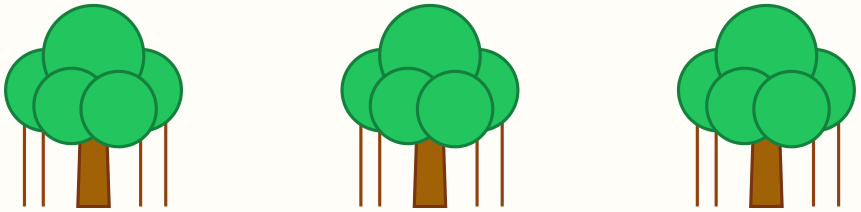
Draw a tree and label 4 parts in Sanskrit

Sacred & Indian trees (1)

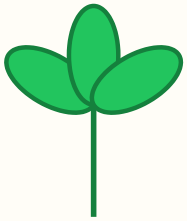


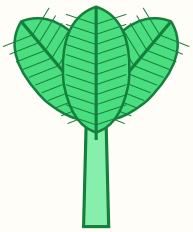
Sanskrit	English · botanical name	Traditional / cultural use
तुलसी tulasī	holy basil *Ocimum tenuiflorum*	Grown in a raised pot (tulasī-vṛndāvana) in the courtyard and worshipped with water and a lamp each day; Tulasī Vivāha is celebrated in Kārtika.
वटः vaṭaḥ	banyan *Ficus benghalensis*	On Vaṭa Pūrṇimā (Vaṭa Sāvitrī) women tie threads around the banyan and pray for their families. Its hanging roots make it a symbol of long life.
अश्वत्थः aśvatthaḥ	peepal, sacred fig *Ficus religiosa*	People walk around (pradakṣiṇā) the aśvattha in temple yards. The Buddha attained enlightenment under one (the Bodhi tree).
निम्बः nimbaḥ	neem *Azadirachta indica*	At Ugādi / Yugādi, a mix of neem flowers and jaggery reminds us that life has both bitter and sweet. Traditionally used in Āyurveda.
आम्रः āmraḥ	mango *Mangifera indica*	Mango leaves are hung as a toraṇa over doorways and placed in the kalaśa at ceremonies.

🌱 **Did you know?** One banyan can grow into a whole “forest”. The Great Banyan in the botanical garden at Howrah, near Kolkata, covers about 1.9 hectares (more than four football fields).



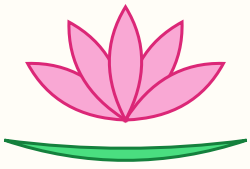
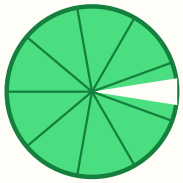
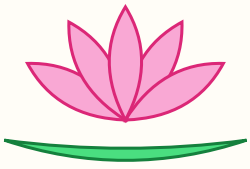
Sacred & Indian trees (2)



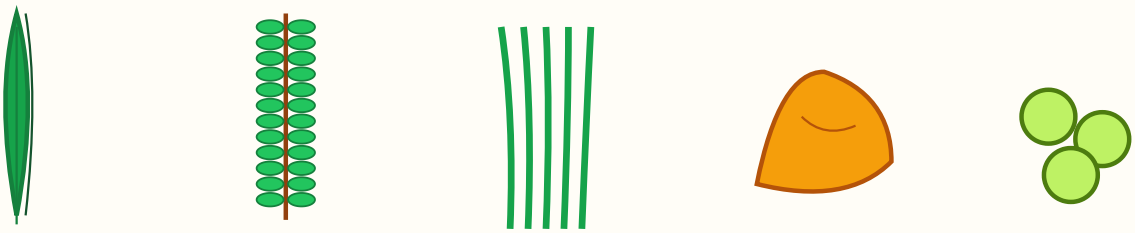




Sanskrit	English · botanical name	Traditional / cultural use
बिल्वः bilvaḥ	bael, wood apple *Aegle marmelos*	Its three-part leaves (bilvapatra) are offered to Śiva.
कमलम् · पद्मम् kamalam · padmam	lotus *Nelumbo nucifera*	India's national flower; Lakṣmī and Sarasvatī are shown seated on a lotus. It grows in mud yet stays clean.
नारिकेलः nārikelaḥ	coconut palm *Cocos nucifera*	A coconut is offered or broken at new beginnings and placed on the kalaśa.
कदली kadalī	banana plant *Musa species*	Banana plants are tied at gateways for weddings and festivals; the leaves are used as plates for festive meals.
चन्दनम् candanam	sandalwood *Santalum album*	Its fragrant paste is used for tilaka and in worship.

🌱 **Did you know?** Water drops roll off a lotus leaf without wetting it. The Gītā (5.10) says a wise person stays untouched like that: पद्मपत्रमिवाम्भसा, "like a lotus leaf by water".

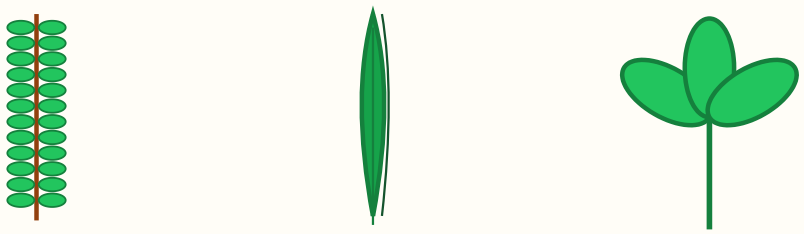




Sacred & Indian trees (3)



Sanskrit	English · botanical name	Traditional / cultural use
अशोकः aśokaḥ	ashoka tree *Saraca asoca*	The name means “without sorrow”. In the Rāmāyaṇa, Sītā stayed in the Aśoka-vana in Laṅkā.
शमी śamī	shami, khejri *Prosopis cineraria*	Worshipped on Vijayadaśamī; its leaves are exchanged as “gold” in some regions.
दूर्वा dūrvā	Bermuda grass *Cynodon dactylon*	Blades of dūrvā, usually in groups of three, are offered to Gaṇeśa.
हरिद्रा haridrā	turmeric *Curcuma longa*	Used in daily cooking, in the haldi ceremony before weddings and to make kuṅkuma. Traditionally used in home remedies.
आमलकी āmalakī	Indian gooseberry, amla *Phyllanthus emblica*	The tree is honoured on Āmalakī Ekādaśī. The fruit is traditionally used in Āyurveda (for example in triphalā).

🌱 **Did you know?** The शमी (khejri) grows even in the Thar desert and is the state tree of Rajasthan.



Practice: trees

Match the tree with its use

Tree	Use
1. तुलसी	a. leaves offered to Gaṇeśa
2. वटः	b. leaves hung as a toraṇa
3. बिल्वः	c. worshipped on Vijayadaśamī
4. दूर्वा	d. grown in the courtyard
5. शमी	e. three-part leaves for Śiva
6. आम्रः	f. worshipped on Vaṭa Pūrṇimā

Write the Sanskrit name

1. banyan _____
2. peepal _____
3. neem _____
4. coconut palm _____
5. turmeric _____
6. sandalwood _____

Botanical names

1. Ocimum tenuiflorum is _____.
2. Nelumbo nucifera is _____.
3. Ficus religiosa is _____.

Ślokas · श्लोकौ

For the aśvattha · अश्वत्थः

मूलतो ब्रह्मरूपाय मध्यतो विष्णुरूपिणे ।
अग्रतः शिवरूपाय वृक्षराजाय ते नमः ॥

mūlato brahmarūpāya madhyato viṣṇurūpiṇe |
agrataḥ śivarūpāya vṛkṣarājāya te namaḥ ||

Meaning: Salutations to you, king of trees, who are Brahmā at the root, Viṣṇu in the middle and Śiva at the top.



For the tulasī · तुलसी

यन्मूले सर्वतीर्थानि यन्मध्ये सर्वदेवताः ।
यदग्रे सर्ववेदाश्च तुलसीं तां नमाम्यहम् ॥

yanmūle sarvatīrthāni yanmadhye sarvadevatāḥ |
yadagre sarvavedāś ca tulasīṃ tāṃ namāmy aham ||

Meaning: I bow to that tulasī at whose root are all the holy places, in whose middle are all the deities and at whose top are all the Vedas.

Notice the words मूलम् (root), मध्यम् (middle) and अग्रम् (top) in both ślokas.

Flowers · पुष्पाणि (1)

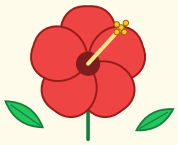
Read each flower name aloud: Devanagari first, then the sound.



कमलम् · पद्मम्
kamalam · padmam
lotus · Nelumbo nucifera



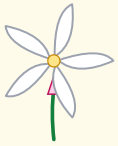
उत्पलम्
utpalam
blue water-lily · Nymphaea nouchali



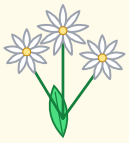
जपा
japā
hibiscus · Hibiscus rosa-sinensis



मल्लिका
mallikā
Arabian jasmine · Jasminum sambac



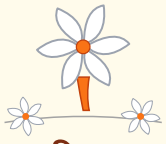
जातिः
jātiḥ
jasmine · Jasminum grandiflorum



कुन्दम्
kundam
star jasmine · Jasminum multiflorum



चम्पकः
campakaḥ
champak · Magnolia champaca



पारिजातः
pārijātaḥ
night jasmine · Nyctanthes arbor-tristis

पुष्पम् and कुसुमम् both mean “flower”. Many Sanskrit poems compare a beautiful face to a lotus (मुखकमलम्, “lotus-face”).

Flowers · पुष्पाणि (2)



केतकी
ketakī
screw-pine flower · Pandanus odorifer



अशोकः
aśokaḥ
aśoka flower · Saraca asoca



करवीरः
karavīraḥ
oleander · Nerium oleander



बकुलः
bakulaḥ
bakul · Mimusops elengi

Flower words · शब्दाः

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
पुष्पम् · कुसुमम्	puṣpam · kusumam	flower
कलिका	kalikā	bud
दलम्	dalam	petal
मकरन्दः	makarandaḥ	nectar
परागः	parāgaḥ	pollen
माला	mālā	garland
सुगन्धः	sugandhaḥ	fragrance
उद्यानम्	udyānam	garden
भ्रमरः	bhramaraḥ	bee (black bee)

Jasmine, champak and pārijāta flowers are strung into garlands and offered in worship; the red japā is often offered to Devī. Pārijāta flowers open at night and fall at dawn.

Practice: flowers (1)

Match · योजयत

Write the letter of the correct name under each picture.



1. ___



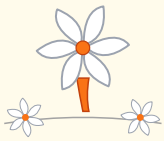
2. ___



3. ___



4. ___



5. ___



6. ___

a. चम्पकः b. करवीरः c. जपा d. पारिजातः e. कमलम् f. अशोकः

Trace and write · अनुलिखत

पुष्पम्	puṣpam
कमलम्	kamalam
मल्लिका	mallikā
पद्मम्	padmam
माला	mālā

Fill in

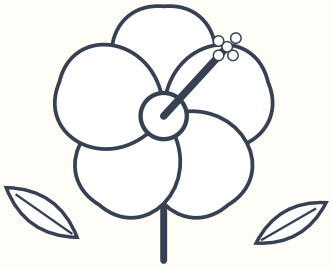
1. A bud is a _____.
2. A petal is a _____.
3. Bees drink _____ (nectar).
4. Night jasmine, which falls at dawn, is _____.

Practice: flowers (2) · रञ्जयत

Colour the flowers · पुष्पाणि रञ्जयत

Colour each flower and write its Sanskrit name on the line.



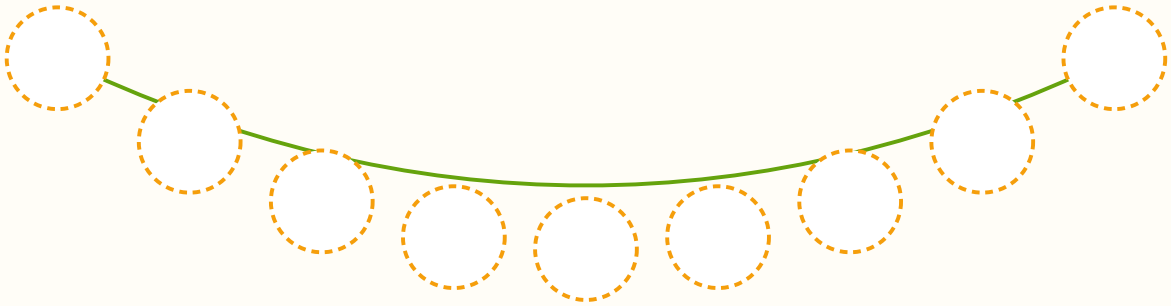






Make a garland · मालां रचयत

Write one flower name in each circle.



Spices · सुगन्धद्रव्याणि



Sanskrit	Sound	English	Botanical name
हरिद्रा	haridrā	turmeric	Curcuma longa
मरिचम्	maricam	black pepper	Piper nigrum
एला	elā	cardamom	Elettaria cardamomum
लवङ्गम्	lavaṅgam	clove	Syzygium aromaticum
जीरकः	jīrakaḥ	cumin	Cuminum cyminum
सर्षपः	sarṣapaḥ	mustard	Brassica juncea
हिङ्गु	hiṅgu	asafoetida	Ferula assa-foetida
शुण्ठी · आर्द्रकम्	śuṇṭhī · ārdrakam	dry ginger · fresh ginger	Zingiber officinale
त्वक्	tvak	cinnamon (bark)	Cinnamomum verum
धान्यकम्	dhānyakam	coriander	Coriandrum sativum
मेथिका	methikā	fenugreek	Trigonella foenum-graecum

Indian kitchens have used these spices for thousands of years; many are traditionally used in home remedies and in Āyurveda.

Grains · धान्यानि



Sanskrit	Sound	English	Botanical name
व्रीहिः	vrīhiḥ	rice (the plant and grain)	Oryza sativa
तण्डुलः	taṇḍulaḥ	husked rice grain	Oryza sativa
यवः	yavaḥ	barley	Hordeum vulgare
गोधूमः	godhūmaḥ	wheat	Triticum aestivum
मुद्गः	mudgaḥ	green gram (moong)	Vigna radiata
माषः	māṣaḥ	black gram (urad)	Vigna mungo
चणकः	caṇakaḥ	chickpea	Cicer arietinum
मसूरः	masūraḥ	red lentil	Lens culinaris
तिलः	tilaḥ	sesame	Sesamum indicum
कङ्गुः	kaṅguḥ	foxtail millet	Setaria italica

व्रीहिः, यवः, तिलः, मुद्गः and माषः are among the grains named in the Vedas. Rice and sesame are used in many rituals; तिलगुडम् (sesame and jaggery) is shared at Makara Saṅkrānti.

Practice: spices & grains

Sort the words · धान्यम् or सुगन्धद्रव्यम्?

गोधूमः · एला · यवः · जीरकः · मुद्गः · लवङ्गम् · चणकः · मरिचम्

Grains (धान्यानि)	Spices (सुगन्धद्रव्याणि)

Write in Sanskrit

1. wheat _____
2. barley _____
3. sesame _____
4. cardamom _____
5. black pepper _____
6. coriander _____

What is in your kitchen today? Write three Sanskrit names.

Sentences & a subhāṣita · वाक्यानि सुभाषितं च

Sanskrit	Meaning
वृक्षः छायां ददाति ।	The tree gives shade.
वृक्षे फलानि सन्ति ।	There are fruits on the tree.
उद्याने पुष्पाणि विकसन्ति ।	Flowers bloom in the garden.
अहं तुलसीं जलेन सिञ्चामि ।	I water the tulasī.
भ्रमरः पुष्पं गच्छति ।	The bee goes to the flower.
वयं वृक्षान् रोपयामः ।	We plant trees.

छायामन्यस्य कुर्वन्ति तिष्ठन्ति स्वयमातपे ।
फलान्यपि परार्थाय वृक्षाः सत्पुरुषा इव ॥

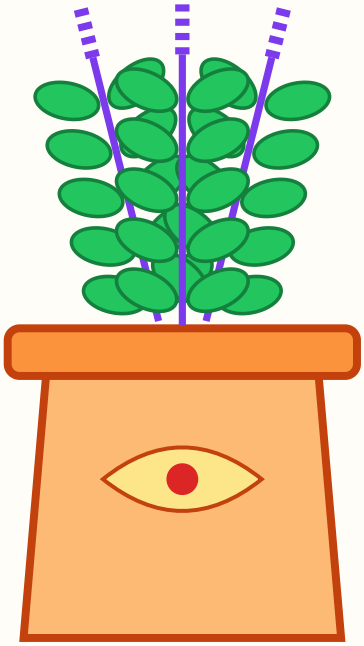
chāyām anyasya kurvanti tiṣṭhanti svayam ātape |
phalāny api parārthāya vṛkṣāḥ satpuruṣā iva ||

Meaning: Trees give shade to others while they themselves stand in the sun; even their fruits are for others. Trees are like good people.





Grow a tulasī · तुलसीं रोपयत



1. Fill a pot with soil and a little compost.
2. Plant a small tulasī cutting or a few seeds.
3. Keep it in a sunny place.
4. Water it a little every day (जलेन सिञ्चत).
5. Pinch off the flower spikes (मञ्जरी) so it grows bushy.

My tulasī log · दिनचर्या

Day	Date	Watered? ✓	Height (cm)	New leaves	Note / drawing
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					
10					
14					
21					
28					

Write one Sanskrit word each day: जलम् · मृत्तिका (soil) · सूर्यः · पर्णम् · मञ्जरी …

Leaf match · पर्णानि योजयत

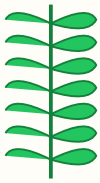
Each leaf has a number. Write the number beside its name.



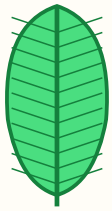
1



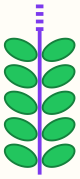
2



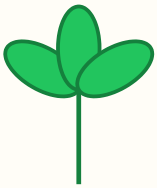
3



4



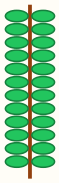
5



6



7



8

अश्वत्थः	peepal (heart-shaped, long tip)	No. ___
बिल्वः	bael (three leaflets)	No. ___
निम्बः	neem (toothed leaflets)	No. ___
शमी	shami (tiny leaflets)	No. ___
तुलसी	holy basil (small soft leaves)	No. ___
आम्रः	mango (long and pointed)	No. ___
वटः	banyan (broad, thick)	No. ___
कदली	banana (huge, with fine lines)	No. ___

Word search · पदान्वेषणम्

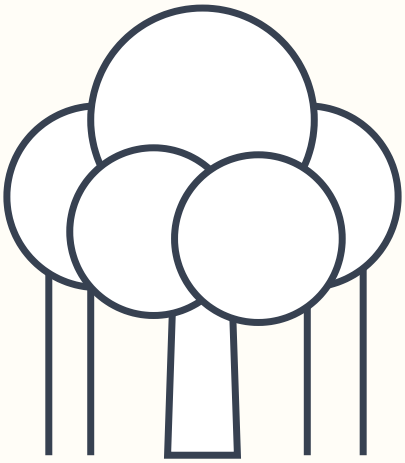
Find the 12 plant words (simple Roman letters without marks). Words go → ↓ or ↘. Write the Sanskrit beside each word.

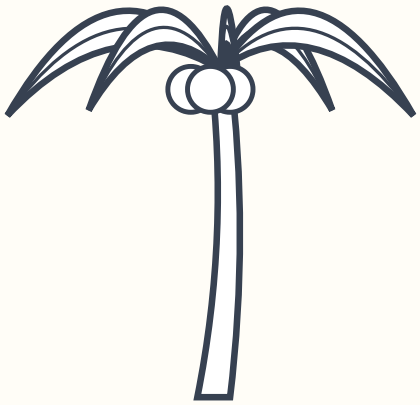
U	K	A	M	A	L	A	Y	H	J	L	C
B	I	L	V	A	K	Y	D	K	L	A	O
D	E	I	D	A	B	A	A	U	P	R	G
T	P	V	H	P	S	H	D	V	R	E	O
Y	U	N	A	D	N	O	H	A	A	V	A
J	S	U	K	T	A	H	G	N	L	V	A
Y	H	U	D	B	A	E	H	T	P	I	T
S	P	N	J	A	M	R	A	U	A	V	I
H	A	L	I	K	N	C	C	L	C	H	L
A	U	Y	I	M	A	V	M	A	M	V	A
M	P	E	U	R	B	U	E	S	N	G	Y
I	E	K	I	V	I	A	H	I	G	Y	T

1. TULASI = _____
2. VATA = _____
3. NIMBA = _____
4. AMRA = _____
5. BILVA = _____
6. KAMALA = _____
7. KADALI = _____
8. SHAMI = _____
9. DURVA = _____
10. YAVA = _____
11. TILA = _____
12. PUSHPA = _____

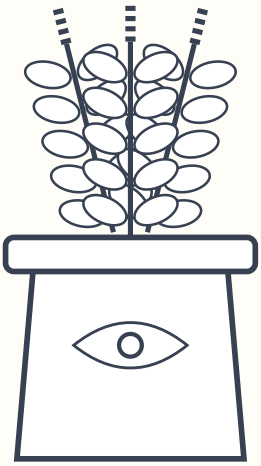
Colour the garden · रञ्जयत

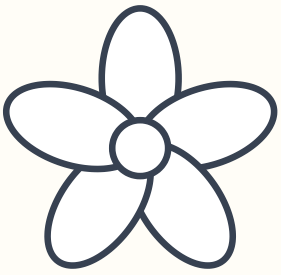
Colour the plants and write each Sanskrit name.

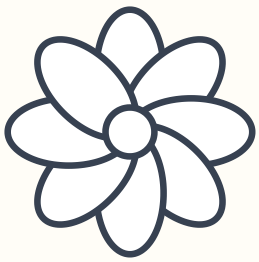


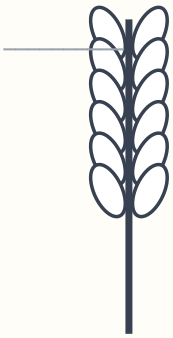












Mixed quiz · मिश्रप्रश्नाः

1. Sanskrit for “root”: _____
2. The tree worshipped on Vaṭa Pūrṇimā: _____
3. Leaves offered to Śiva: _____
4. India’s national flower in Sanskrit: _____
5. Botanical name of turmeric: _____
6. गोधूमः means _____.
7. Sanskrit for “seed”: _____
8. The plant grown in a tulasī-vṛndāvana: _____
9. अशोकः means “without _____”.
10. Grass offered to Gaṇeśa: _____
11. In the subhāṣita, trees are like _____.
12. तिलः means _____.

True or false

1. Neem flowers and jaggery are eaten at Ugādi. _____
2. The aśvattha śloka says Viṣṇu is at the root. _____
3. चम्पकः is a yellow, fragrant flower. _____

Answer key · उत्तराणि (1)

Parts of a plant

Label: 1 मूलम् · 2 काण्डः · 3 शाखा · 4 पर्णम् · 5 पुष्पम् · 6 फलम् · 7 बीजम्. Fill: मूलम् · पुष्पम् · बीजम् · पर्णम्, पत्रम्

Trees

Match: 1d · 2f · 3e · 4a · 5c · 6b. Names: वटः · अश्वत्थः · निम्बः · नारिकेलः · हरिद्रा · चन्दनम्. Botanical: तुलसी · कमलम् (पद्मम्) · अश्वत्थः

Flowers

Match: 1c (जपा) · 2e (कमलम्) · 3a (चम्पकः) · 4f (अशोकः) · 5d (पारिजातः) · 6b (करवीरः). Fill: कलिका · दलम् · मकरन्दः · पारिजातः. Colouring: कमलम् / पद्मम् · जपा · चम्पकः · करवीरः

Spices & grains

Grains: गोधूमः, यवः, मुद्गः, चणकः. Spices: एला, जीरकः, लवङ्गम्, मरिचम्. Write: गोधूमः · यवः · तिलः · एला · मरिचम् · धान्यकम्

Answer key · उत्तराणि (2)

Leaf match

अश्वत्थः 1 · बिल्वः 6 · निम्बः 3 · शमी 8 · तुलसी 5 · आम्रः 2 · वटः 7 · कदली 4

Word search

TULASI तुलसी · VATA वटः · NIMBA निम्बः · AMRA आम्रः · BILVA बिल्वः · KAMALA कमलम् · KADALI कदली · SHAMI शमी · DURVA दूर्वा · YAVA यवः · TILA तिलः · PUSHPA पुष्पम्

Start (row, column) and direction: TULASI 7,9 ↓ · VATA 4,3 ↘ · NIMBA 8,3 ↘ · AMRA 8,5 → · BILVA 2,1 → · KAMALA 1,2 → · KADALI 2,6 ↘ · SHAMI 8,1 ↓ · DURVA 2,8 ↘ · YAVA 2,7 ↘ · TILA 7,12 ↓ · PUSHPA 4,2 ↓

Mixed quiz

1 मूलम् · 2 वटः · 3 बिल्वः (bilvapatra) · 4 कमलम् / पद्मम् · 5 Curcuma longa · 6 wheat · 7 बीजम् · 8 तुलसी · 9 sorrow · 10 दूर्वा · 11 good people (सत्पुरुषाः) · 12 sesame. True/false: true · false (Brahmā at the root) · true

> शोभनम्! Well done! · वृक्षो रक्षति रक्षितः । (A tree protected protects us.)